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Location

Perth, Western Australia



Education

- Master of Cyber Security
 - Bachelor of Science (Cyber Security)
- Edith Cowan University**

- Mechatronic Engineering Honours and Computer Science Double Degree Major
- Curtin University**
Discontinued due to passion for cyber security.



Certifications

- Certified Defensive Security Analyst (CDSA)
HackTheBox
- eLearning Web App Penetration Tester (eWPT)
- eLearning Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT)
INE
- Fundamentals of Incident Response (FIRE)
Trustwave
- Immersive Labs (defensive courses, continuous)
Huntress
- CISA 401v
- CISA 301v
- CISA 210w
- CISA 100w
U.S. Department of Homeland Security
- Dragos Platform Certified User
Dragos

Joshua Kiriakoff

SOC Analyst

Security operations analyst who builds and validates detections alongside the alert queue. Josh combines his offensive security foundation to give him an edge in incident response, detection engineering, and proactive and retrospective threat hunting. Josh leads complex investigations and executes evidence-backed containment decisions, including endpoint and environment isolation during active compromises.

Josh uses investigation findings to develop behavioural detection improvements. He combines hands-on malware analysis with a practical understanding of attacker tradecraft, translating complex technical evidence into clear investigative findings and defensive guidance for a non-technical audience.



Experience

September 2025 - Current

Huntress | Perth WA, Australia

SOC Analyst

Detection Engineering and Threat Hunting

- Credited author on 13 Sigma rules in the production detection repository since January 2026, including 9 rated P1/P2, covering EDR process telemetry, autoruns, named pipes, SIEM script blocks, correlation and hunting. Submit detection work through Detection Engineering's pull-request and detector-ticket pathways alongside SOC alert-queue responsibilities.
- Authored 4 pull requests to the detection repository, 3 of which merged. Every merged rule included positive and negative test cases with detection-engine and ELK validation. One persistence rule was promoted from P5 to P2 six days after merge, following a soak with no observed false positives. A proposed RMM indicator was adopted into a stable P2 rule after a P6 soak produced no observed false positives.
- Raised 20 detector tickets with Sigma logic and test cases attached; 13 are traceable to merged rule changes. These include tuning a P1 offensive-security tool detection and a P2 social-engineering payload detection, with the latter covering two command variants.
- Validate every rule and change request against Detection Engineering best practices before review. Run unit tests against expanded positive and negative test data, and perform schema and lint checks. Confirm rules match as intended using the specified detection-engine version. Define searches of production telemetry for potential false positives before merging rules.
- Identified three coverage gaps and one dead rule within one month, raising workflow tickets that led to fixes by Detection Engineering. Findings included an RMM rule that matched an unintended deployment type, a BYOVD rule that had never fired, and a social-engineering payload that evaded three existing detection conditions.
- Developed an RMM hunting script using the Elastic API and threat-intelligence enrichment to identify suspicious deployments. Within its first week, it surfaced 15 malicious instances that existing detectors had missed and contributed to a co-credited hunting rule.
- Run hypothesis-driven ES|QL hunts across hosts, command lines and process lineage. One hunt surfaced previously undetected persistence following a social-engineering intrusion, prompting TR to sweep the partner's domain. The investigation led to a detection-coverage sprint.
- Pursue self-directed learning seeking Detection Engineering and Product Management guidance on resources and rule-development workflows. . Aim to automate repetitive SOC tasks, reduce workload and accelerate response to protect customer environments.

Incident Response and Investigations

- Own Managed EDR and Managed SIEM investigations end-to-end for a global partner base, from triage and forensic scoping to containment and final reporting. Executed approximately 130 mass-isolation containments across 15,000+ endpoints, spanning 371 organisations, including a 72-organisation, 2,000-endpoint MSP ScreenConnect compromise.
- Investigated a targeted intrusion, covering SpecterBroker token theft, Apple-signed DLL sideloading, Get-PRT Entra token theft and a .NET backdoor. Reverse-engineered the backdoor and matched its obfuscation salts reported in Bitdefender's Stubbedoor report, pointing to an APT-backed operator. Turned the observed tradecraft into 4 detection rules.
- Independently made a re-isolation call on an Akira-ransomed domain controller after finding an AnyDesk installation that the original response had missed, then confirmed from the AnyDesk trace logs that the attacker had retained access.
- Led the end-to-end response to a critical MSP incident in which a threat actor abused a partner's compromised Bomgar (BeyondTrust Remote Support) instance to create rogue administrators and deploy AnyDesk and NetScan across downstream client environments. Drove account-wide containment across 78 organisations.
- Traced WsusService.exe activity to an obfuscated PowerShell script enumerating multiple partner domains. The analysis assisted in identifying zero-day exploitation of WSUS CVE-2025-59287. It also contributed to Huntress's same-day public advisory.

Tooling, Research and Enablement

- Designed and shipped a SOC-wide triage module that matches host process telemetry against open-source threat-intelligence datasets covering approximately 140,000 indicators.
- Perform static and dynamic malware analysis in a snapshot-based lab with Ghidra, Binary Ninja and Volatility 3. Publish selected findings as first-author Huntress research, including the MacSync Stealer and RAT reverse-engineering series.
- Report attacker-controlled accounts, services and repositories to platform providers for takedown, including a compromised repository subsequently removed by GitHub.
- Coach associate and fellow SOC analysts on Sigma authoring, unit-test preparation and the detector-request workflow, including drafting ticket-ready requests. Guide peers in hunting methods, tool use and analytical frameworks such as the Diamond Model of Intrusion Analysis.



Languages

- Python
- Java
- C++
- Powershell
- Bash
- ES | QL
- Elastic (Kibana)
- Sigma
- Yaml



Publications

- MacSync Stealer Kill Chain and RE
- The Devil
- Komari Red

Huntress

- Let's ClickFix Some Errors
- No Malware at All

Personal Research



Presentations

- Tradecraft Tuesday

Huntress



Contributions

- N-able Vulnerability Exploitation
- SonicWall Credential Stuffing Campaign
- Exploitation of WSUS RCE Vulnerability
- Uptick Bomgar Exploitation
- Supply Chain Compromise Axios npm Package

Huntress



Experience (cont'd)

October 2024 - September 2025

Deloitte | Perth WA, Australia

SOC Analyst

- Leveraged industry-standard SIEM and EDR platforms, including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon, Carbon Black, Splunk, and Elastic, to continuously monitor enterprise systems and networks, effectively detecting and responding to security events.
- Correlated alert data against the MITRE ATT&CK framework to accurately identify adversarial tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs), enabling rapid classification, escalation, and targeted remediation of potential threats.
- Developed, built and tuned detection rules, dashboards, and alerts in collaboration with engineering teams, improving SOC visibility, reducing false positives, and streamlining event triage.
- Conducted in-depth threat hunting activities by correlating telemetry, threat intelligence, and attack patterns, resulting in enhanced alert fidelity, reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Utilised established ticketing and incident management platforms to streamline the triaging process with clients, diligently documenting investigations, maintaining clear audit trails, and ensuring timely resolution of incidents in accordance with strict SLAs.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including Red Team, Incident Response, and Threat Intelligence resulting in refined detection rules, enhanced SOC playbooks, and aligned incident response strategies with the evolving threat landscapes.
- Executed multiple purple cross-team exercises from a coupled red and blue team perspective, simulating adversarial TTPs to test control effectiveness while leveraging defensive insights to validate detection logic. This resulted in improved alert fidelity, enhanced security controls, and the remediation of critical visibility gaps.
- Conducted regular tabletop exercises and scenario-based simulations that aligned with MITRE ATT&CK to validate detection capabilities, improve the SOC's maturity, and instil confidence in our team's readiness.
- Facilitated knowledge sharing and on-the-job training for junior analysts, promoting SOC methodologies, best practices, and the effective use of security tools.

July 2023 - October 2024

Deloitte | Perth WA, Australia

Graduate Cyber Security Analyst

- Orchestrated red team operations using the MITRE ATT&CK framework to simulate adversarial tactics and techniques, enhancing the client's defensive strategies.
- Identification of IT/OT vulnerabilities by analysing systems, networks and communications in conjunction with advising appropriate security mitigations.
- Delivered Operational Technology (OT) security assessments for critical infrastructure clients against ISO/IEC 27001:2022 and NIST 800-82, and framework implementations aligned to AS 7770:2018 across design, build and maintenance.
- Utilised ISA/IEC 62443 for multiple clients, focusing on identifying and addressing security gaps in OT critical infrastructure, promoting a culture of resilience and proactive risk management.
- Implemented cyber security frameworks aligned to AS7770:2018 that identified and addressed vulnerabilities across operational and business infrastructures, incorporating cyber security measures throughout the Design, Build, and Maintenance phases, and provided continuous advisory support to enhance system resilience and regulatory compliance.
- Provisioned Splunk servers, which resulted in significantly improved network data capture capabilities, enhancing visibility and analysis for more effective monitoring and incident response.
- Provided GRC consulting, with particular focus in NIST CSF, Essential Eight, AESCSFv1 & v2 and CPS 234, contributing to business growth and supporting expansion initiatives across various industries.
- Established the Operational Technology Cyber Security (OTCS) Lab to test, learn and simulate real-world cyber attacks on OT/IT infrastructure.
- Provided guidance and training on industry-standard penetration testing techniques and tools to interns/undergraduate colleagues, fostering a culture of continuous learning and security awareness.
- First place in the Deloitte Vac Hack CTF across Australia.



Experience (cont'd)

May 2022 - January 2023

Self-Employed | Disclosed Reports: 3

Bug Bounty Hunter / Web App Penetration Tester

- Performed web-app vulnerability assessments for an ASX-50 entity and delivered detailed findings and recommendations, including findings of a P2 incident.
- Orchestrated web application assessments based on the MITRE ATT&CK framework to simulate adversarial tactics and techniques, enhancing the client's defensive strategies.
- Exploited vulnerabilities in web applications in accordance with the OWASP Web Security Testing Guide.
- Extracted information from websites using passive and active reconnaissance & OSINT.
- Analysis of web applications to identify potential attack vectors, including hidden files, directories and misconfigurations.
- Exploited directory traversal, file upload, LFI, and RFI vulnerabilities for information disclosure and remote code execution.
- Successfully exploited session management and command injection vulnerabilities.
- Through Joshua's involvement with web/application-based penetration, he developed a comprehensive understanding of, but not limited to:
 - 403 Bypass techniques (Proxy Bypassing).
 - Blind & Traditional SQL Injection.
 - Code & Command Injection.
 - Cross-Site & Server-Side Request Forgery.
 - Cross-Site Scripting (Reflective and DOM-based).
 - Exploiting Vulnerable Server & Service Versions.
 - File Upload Filter Bypassing.
 - Host Header Poisoning.
 - HTTP Request Smuggling.
 - ISS Tilde Enumeration.
 - Local File Path Manipulation.
 - LFI & RFI.
 - Out-of-Band Resource Loading.
 - Web Cache Poisoning.

January 2022 - November 2022

Empired/Capgemini | Perth WA, Australia

Technical Support Engineer

- Gathered an in-depth knowledge of a range of software, hardware, and operating systems. This included but is not limited to, Azure Active Directory for user account management and access control, ServiceNow for incident reporting, management and triaging, Azure for cloud services management, Citrix for virtual desktop infrastructure, and Cisco systems for network security and VPN tunnelling.
- Created, adjusted and troubleshoot Bash scripts that would be used to automate long and complex tasks, such as checking user privileges.
- Conducted troubleshooting to resolve users' IT-related hardware/software issues.
- Communicated complex information in an easily understood format to a diverse user base.
- Created and maintained detailed technical documentation and best practice guides based on industry standards.

January 2020 - August 2023

Supercheap Auto | Perth WA, Australia

Retail Supervisor

- Oversaw daily operations and ensured process efficiency during a three-year tenure.
- Managed a diverse team, coordinated staff schedules, and handled inventory control.
- Developed and conducted staff training programs, improving sales techniques and product knowledge.
- Managed customer relations, handling inquiries, complaints, and feedback with professionalism.
- Communicated complex policies and promotions clearly, fostering a customer-centric environment.
- Maintained detailed operational documentation and best practice guides.
- Proactively troubleshoot operational issues to minimise downtime and sustain business continuity.



References

Available Upon Request